Research methods

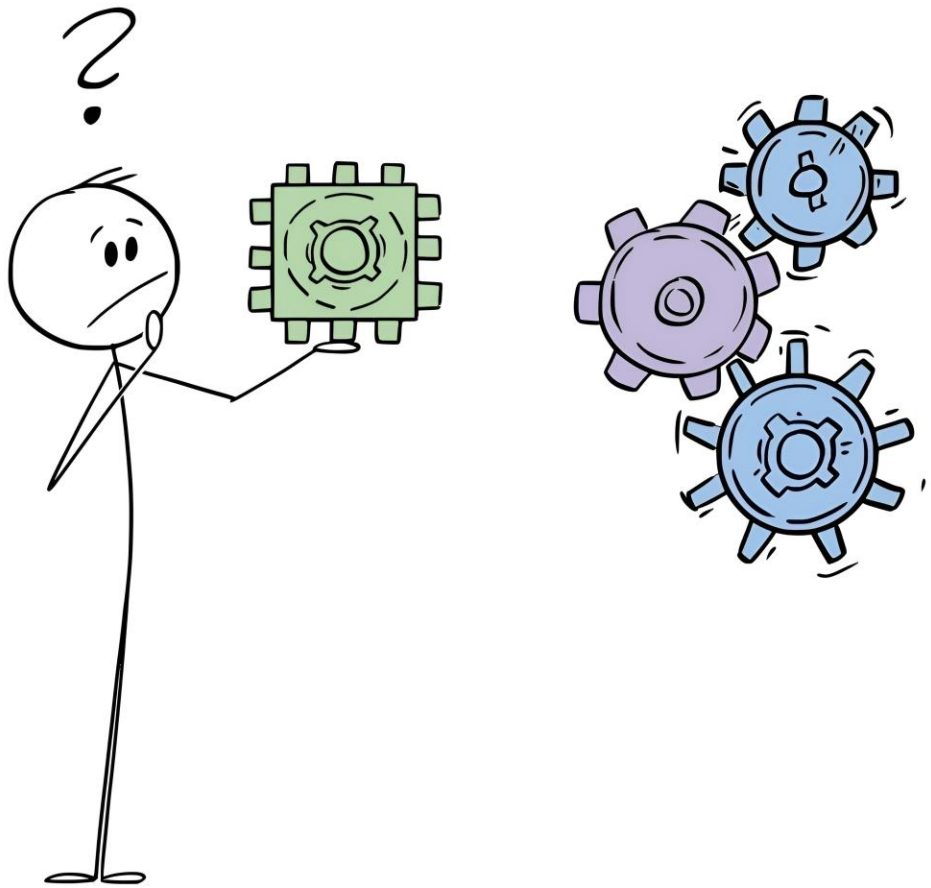


Plan for today

(1) The main parts of your research project

(2) Questions about your projects answered

The main parts of your research project



The main parts of your research project



what's already been done



research problem



research topic



research question



method



research aim

The main parts of your research project

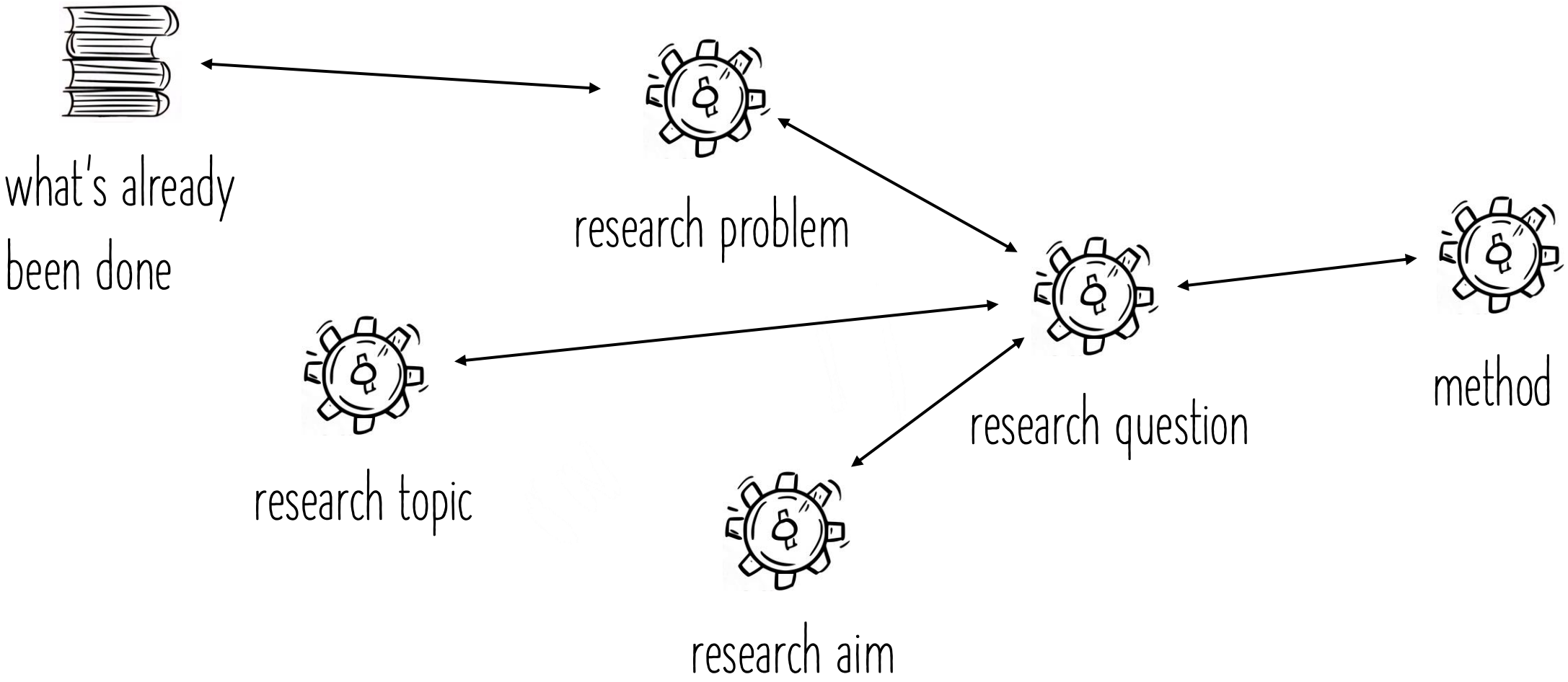
At this point, maybe some of these parts are already clear. Maybe most, or even all of them, are clear. Or maybe none of them are clear.

This is fine. There is time.

The main parts of your research project

One important thing to remember while you are developing the parts of your project is that they are interdependent.

The main parts of your research project



The main parts of your research project

One of the first things that you'll need to do is to turn your research topic into a research question.

For some projects, it's easier and more natural to formulate the research problem or aim rather than the research question. If so, this can be the first thing that you do.

The main parts of your research project

There are different ways to go about turning your research topic into a research question or problem or aim.

The main parts of your research project



what's already been done



research problem





research topic



research question



method



research aim

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what's already been done



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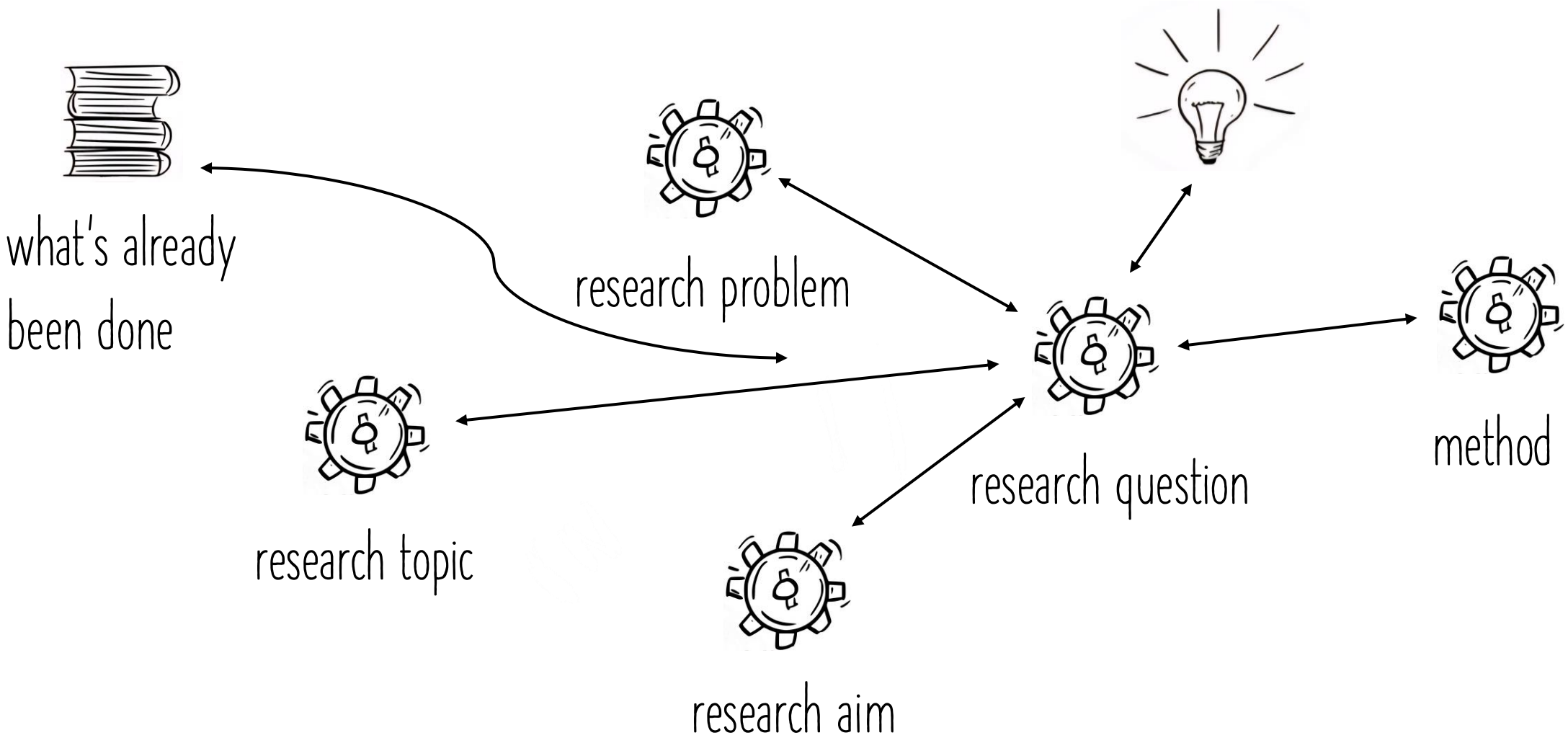


research aim



method

The main parts of your research project



The main parts of your research project

Important to remember, your research question needs to be clear, precise, and specific.

It is also a convention that research questions are not too long. So, once you have formulated your research question as clearly, precisely, and specifically as you can, if it is too long, you can probably move some of the details to your discussion of your method.

The main parts of your research project

Research problems can vary according to discipline. In some disciplines, like applied mathematics, the research problem is often very specific. In other disciplines, including the social sciences, the research problem can be more general.

The main parts of your research project

Your research aim should correspond to your research question. That is, once you've achieved your aim, you have also answered your research question and vice versa.

In some disciplines, it is more common to have more than one research question (and thus more than one aim).

The main parts of your research project

One helpful way to think about your method is: Question in, answer out. That is, your method should be everything that you need to do in order to get a clear answer to your question.

Given that your research aim should correspond to your research question, another helpful way to think about your method is: Aim, aim achieved. That is, your method should be everything that you need to do to clearly achieve your aim.

Questions about your projects answered

